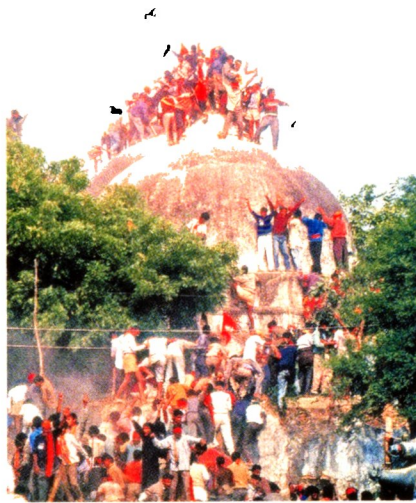


LUCKNOW | Paper Chase

Are the babus in Uttar Pradesh concealing documents related to the Ram janma bhoomi-Babri Masjid in Ayodhya to mislead the court? One of the documents includes an urgent telegram from then prime minister Jawaharlal Nehru in January 1949 to Govind Ballabh Pant asking him to remove idols of Lord Rama from the disputed mandir. The Lucknow bench of the Allahabad High Court has now asked the chief secretary to file a report on the "non-availability of documents". S.A. Siddiqui, who is pleading the case on behalf of Babri Masjid advocates, says, "There may be a deliberate design behind the non-availability to mislead the court. If the documents are produced before the bench, they may provide conclusive evidence that a mosque existed and the idols were placed surreptitiously on the night of October 22-23, 1949."

by Subhash Mishra

THE BABRI MASJID



MUMBAI | Report Row

The Pradhan Committee's report accusing Mumbai Police Commissioner Hasan Gafoor of failing to lead his team of officers during the 26/11 attacks is not without flaws. The report blames Gafoor of inefficiency while lauding the role of the Mumbai Police. Gafoor's replacement, D. Sivanandan, was the additional director-general of the Maharashtra State Intelligence Department when the attacks took place. Since the attacks were attributed to an intelligence failure, Sivanandan's appointment is already raising eyebrows.

by Swati Mathur

Soft Talk

Manmohan Singh has repeatedly been saying that there will be no talks with Pakistan until it takes action against the perpetrators of 26/11. Would the prime minister care to explain what he was doing for 40 minutes with Asif Ali Zardari in Yekaterinburg, Russia, on June 16?



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